SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

6 September 2023 · Shift 3

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.9

What will be the amount due on ₹24,000 in 2 years when the rate of simple interest on successive years is 4% per annum and 5% per annum, respectively?

(A) ₹24,960
(B) ₹25,200
(C) ₹26,208
(D) ₹26,160

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

Which of the following countries did India beat to win the Men's Hockey Junior Asia Cup 2023?

(A) South Korea
(B) Thailand
(C) Pakistan
(D) Japan

Q.2

In the realm of soil science, humus is considered:

(A) synthetic additive
(B) decaying organic matter in soil
(C) mineral-rich compound
(D) inorganic material

Q.3

Which group of crops belong to fibre crops and are produced on a large scale in India?

(A) Gram and tur
(B) Jute and hemp
(C) Tea and coffee
(D) Wheat and rice

Q.4

Name the life-threatening disease caused by protozoa of the genus Trypanosoma that is transmitted to human hosts through the bite of infected tsetse flies.

(A) Sleeping sickness
(B) Chagas disease
(C) Giardiasis
(D) Kala-azar

Q.5

Who is an acclaimed Kathak dancer with many awards to his credit?

(A) Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma
(B) Ustad Alla Rakha
(C) Pandit Birju Maharaj
(D) Ustad Bismillah Khan

Q.6

'Pinjar' is a novel by _____.

(A) Kiran Desai
(B) Kamala Das
(C) Anita Desai
(D) Amrita Pritam

Q.7

When was the Asian Games organised in India for the second time?

(A) 1994
(B) 1986
(C) 1982
(D) 1998

Q.8

Who nominates members to the Rajya Sabha based on their excellence in literature, science, art and social service?

(A) The Chief Justice of India
(B) The President
(C) The Chairman of the Rajya Sabha
(D) The Prime Minister

Q.9

Which Indian musician is associated with the Flute?

(A) Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia
(B) Ustad Zakir Hussain
(C) Pandit Ravi Shankar
(D) Ustad Allahrakha

Q.10

The black soil area of the _____ is known as the Deccan Trap.

(A) Northern Plains
(B) Peninsular Plateau
(C) Coastal Plains
(D) Himalayan Mountains

Q.11

When did the British East India Company start the 'permanent settlement system'?

(A) 1793 CE
(B) 1773 CE
(C) 1799 CE
(D) 1780 CE

Q.12

The word 'Swaraj' was first used by Dadabhai Naoroji in the Congress session held in which place?

(A) Madras
(B) Surat
(C) Calcutta
(D) Lucknow

Q.13

Chhau, identified by the Ministry of Culture as a classical dance, is prevalent in eastern India and has three distinct forms. Which of the following is NOT one of them?

(A) Seraikela Chhau of Jharkhand
(B) Marwahi Chhau of Chhattisgarh
(C) Purulia Chhau of West Bengal
(D) Mayurbhanj Chhau of Odisha

Q.14

According to the Global Multidimensional Poverty Index 2022, which of the following states is NOT included in 10 poorest states?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Assam
(C) Odisha
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.15
Which Clause of Article 19 of the Indian Constitution guarantees the 'right to move freely throughout the territory of India'?

(A) Clause (b)
(B) Clause (c)
(C) Clause (d)
(D) Clause (a)

Q.17
The President of India conferred the Padma Shri award to Sanathoiba Sharma for his distinguished service in the field of _____ in 2023.

(A) Mukna
(B) Khong Kangjei
(C) Thang-Ta
(D) Yubi Lakpi

Q.18
Rikham pada dance belongs to which of the following states?

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Assam
(C) Mizoram
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.19
Which theory was published by John Dalton in 1808 to explain chemical reactions?

(A) Atomic theory
(B) Valence bond theory
(C) Quantum field theory
(D) Molecular orbital theory

Q.20
What is the main function of money in an economy?

(A) To regulate interest rates
(B) To create wealth
(C) To facilitate exchange
(D) To control inflation

Q.21
Who among the following designed the India Gate?

(A) Lord Wavell
(B) Lord Dalhousie
(C) Edwin Lutyens
(D) John Nash

Q.22
In 2022, the Centre constituted a committee headed by former Union Agriculture Secretary _____ to look into the issues of minimum support price (MSP).

(A) Sanjay Agrawal
(B) P Chandrashekhar
(C) Radha Mohan Singh
(D) JP Sharma

Q.23
One of the prominent festivals celebrated in _____ is the 'Me-Dum-Me-Phi', i.e., the ancestor worship festival.

(A) Assam
(B) Nagaland
(C) Manipur
(D) Meghalaya

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Be like chalk and cheese

(A) To be completely different from each other
(B) To be very similar to each other
(C) To have a close relation with another person
(D) To be distantly related to each other

Q.2
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Everyone liked the “lively” music being played at the restaurant.

(A) Durable
(B) Cheerful
(C) Speedy
(D) Sombre

Q.3
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Fourty
(B) Committee
(C) Hypnotic
(D) Tennessee

Q.4
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined segment in the following sentence. Raymond has opted “the study of religion” as his major subject in graduation.

(A) Psephology
(B) Philology
(C) Theology
(D) Psychology

Q.5
Select the most appropriate idiom from the given options to fill in the blank. Greta Thunberg _____ when she dared to question about accountability with respect to global warming and climate change.

(A) sowed wild oats
(B) kept the pot boiling
(C) gave the devil his due
(D) hit the nail on the head

Q.6
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. When Rajesh was going to college, he “meet” with an accident.

(A) has met
(B) meets
(C) met
(D) No substitution required

Q.7
Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. “As soon as” I “shall win” the lottery, I “hope” to buy “a Ferrari”.

(A) hope
(B) As soon as
(C) shall win
(D) a Ferrari

Q.8
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Some things are meant to be, and death is _____ for humans.

(A) edible
(B) spiral
(C) natural
(D) viral

Q.9
Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. They complained that their manager was “incompietent” and knew nothing about the project.

(A) incompitent
(B) incompeteant
(C) incomepetent
(D) incompetent

Q.10
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Distinguished

(A) Mirrored
(B) Dignified
(C) Dramatic
(D) Mediocre

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Periodic

(A) Holistic
(B) Dynamic
(C) Irregular
(D) Tedious

Q.12

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. Manisha saw an old elephant / in the wildlife reserve / while she was / on safari tour.

(A) on safari tour
(B) Manisha saw an old elephant
(C) while she was
(D) in the wildlife reserve

Q.13

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. In Nepal, the food is more cheaper than in Sri Lanka.

(A) more cheaper
(B) the food is
(C) than in Sri Lanka
(D) In Nepal

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Most times, he is sitting alone, immersed in his own _____.

(A) synagogue
(B) monologue
(C) mystagogue
(D) prologue

Q.15

Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence and select its correct spelling from the given options. He has neither the policies nor the persanol charisma to inspire people.

(A) cherisma
(B) polecies
(C) personal
(D) niether

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. The judge wanted to hear “straight from the horse’s mouth”.

(A) Directly from the lawyer
(B) Directly from the person involved
(C) In close vicinity to the juror
(D) Having ears which never fail

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. Virtual reality is the creation of a virtual environment “presented to our senses” in such a way that we experience it as if we were really there.

(A) presenting to our senses
(B) presenting in our senses
(C) presents to our senses
(D) No substitution required

Q.18

Select the most appropriate idiom from the given options to fill in the blank. Being a journalist, your first duty is to _____ or else your colleagues might surpass you.

(A) eat a humble pie
(B) have an axe to grind
(C) build castles in the air
(D) keep your ear to the ground

Q.19

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) He will come / (B) and receive you / (C) at the station / (D) when you will arrive.

(A) A
(B) B
(C) C
(D) D

Q.20

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. She is very good / in playing / the guitar / and singing songs.

(A) in playing
(B) and singing songs
(C) the guitar
(D) She is very good

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Environmental pollution is a growing (1)_____ all around the world as it poses significant risks to human health and ecosystems. The (2)_____ of environmental pollution vary from natural causes such as volcanic emissions to human actions, including industrialisation, transportation, energy production and agricultural practices. (3)_____ of these activities, pollutants are released into the air, water bodies and soil leading to harmful effects such as respiratory diseases, loss of biodiversity and climate change. One of the primary causes of environmental pollution is human attitudes towards sustainability (4)_____ their lack of environmental awareness. Human activities that harm the environment and ecosystem often result from individual choices (5)_____ driving or using single-use plastics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) interest
(B) duty
(C) concern
(D) charge

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Environmental pollution is a growing (1)_____ all around the world as it poses significant risks to human health and ecosystems. The (2)_____ of environmental pollution vary from natural causes such as volcanic emissions to human actions, including industrialisation, transportation, energy production and agricultural practices. (3)_____ of these activities, pollutants are released into the air, water bodies and soil leading to harmful effects such as respiratory diseases, loss of biodiversity and climate change. One of the primary causes of environmental pollution is human attitudes towards sustainability (4)_____ their lack of environmental awareness. Human activities that harm the environment and ecosystem often result from individual choices (5)_____ driving or using single-use plastics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) sourcing
(B) sources
(C) sourced
(D) source

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Environmental pollution is a growing (1)_____ all around the world as it poses significant risks to human health and ecosystems. The (2)_____ of environmental pollution vary from natural causes such as volcanic emissions to human actions, including industrialisation, transportation, energy production and agricultural practices. (3)_____ of these activities, pollutants are released into the air, water bodies and soil leading to harmful effects such as respiratory diseases, loss of biodiversity and climate change. One of the primary causes of environmental pollution is human attitudes towards sustainability (4)_____ their lack of environmental awareness. Human activities that harm the environment and ecosystem often result from individual choices (5)_____ driving or using single-use plastics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) Since
(B) However
(C) As a result
(D) Therefore

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Environmental pollution is a growing (1)_____ all around the world as it poses significant risks to human health and ecosystems. The (2)_____ of environmental pollution vary from natural causes such as volcanic emissions to human actions, including industrialisation, transportation, energy production and agricultural practices. (3)_____ of these activities, pollutants are released into the air, water bodies and soil leading to harmful effects such as respiratory diseases, loss of biodiversity and climate change. One of the primary causes of environmental pollution is human attitudes towards sustainability (4)_____ their lack of environmental awareness. Human activities that harm the environment and ecosystem often result from individual choices (5)_____ driving or using single-use plastics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) and
(B) since
(C) but
(D) because

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Environmental pollution is a growing (1)_____ all around the world as it poses significant risks to human health and ecosystems. The (2)_____ of environmental pollution vary from natural causes such as volcanic emissions to human actions, including industrialisation, transportation, energy production and agricultural practices. (3)_____ of these activities, pollutants are released into the air, water bodies and soil leading to harmful effects such as respiratory diseases, loss of biodiversity and climate change. One of the primary causes of environmental pollution is human attitudes towards sustainability (4)_____ their lack of environmental awareness. Human activities that harm the environment and ecosystem often result from individual choices (5)_____ driving or using single-use plastics.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) example
(B) while
(C) like
(D) instance

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.9 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.9 · Answer (D) ₹26,160

Interest for the first year = 4% of ₹24,000 = ₹960 and for the second = 5% of ₹24,000 = ₹1,200. Amount = 24,000 + 960 + 1,200 = ₹26,160.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Pakistan

India beat Pakistan 2-1 in the final at Salalah, Oman, in June 2023 to win the Men's Junior Asia Cup for the fourth time.

Q.2 · Answer (B) decaying organic matter in soil

Humus is the dark, decaying organic matter in soil, formed from dead plants and animals; it adds nutrients and helps the soil hold water.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Jute and hemp

NCERT names cotton, jute, hemp and natural silk as India's four major fibre crops. Gram and tur are pulses, tea and coffee beverage crops, and wheat and rice cereals.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Sleeping sickness

Sleeping sickness (African trypanosomiasis) is caused by Trypanosoma brucei and spread by tsetse flies. Chagas disease, caused by Trypanosoma cruzi, is spread by triatomine bugs, and kala-azar by sandflies.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Pandit Birju Maharaj

Pandit Birju Maharaj of the Lucknow gharana was the leading Kathak dancer of his time. Shiv Kumar Sharma played the santoor, Alla Rakha the tabla and Bismillah Khan the shehnai.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Amrita Pritam

'Pinjar' (1950) is Amrita Pritam's Punjabi novel set against the violence of Partition.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 1982

New Delhi hosted the first Asian Games in 1951 and the ninth, India's second, in 1982.

Q.8 · Answer (B) The President

Under Article 80 the President nominates 12 members of the Rajya Sabha with special knowledge or practical experience in literature, science, art and social service.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia

Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is the best-known exponent of the bansuri, the bamboo flute. Zakir Hussain and Alla Rakha played the tabla and Ravi Shankar the sitar.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Peninsular Plateau

NCERT describes the black soil area known as the Deccan Trap as a distinct feature of the Peninsular Plateau; it is of volcanic origin, so its rocks are igneous.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 1793 CE

Lord Cornwallis introduced the Permanent Settlement in Bengal in 1793, fixing the zamindars' land revenue in perpetuity.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Calcutta

Presiding over the Calcutta session of 1906, Dadabhai Naoroji declared 'Swaraj' (self-government) the goal of the Congress, the first time the word was used from its platform.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Marwahi Chhau of Chhattisgarh

Chhau's three styles are named after where they are danced: Seraikela in Jharkhand, Purulia in West Bengal and Mayurbhanj in Odisha. There is no Marwahi Chhau.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Gujarat
The Global MPI 2022 (UNDP and OPHI) found Bihar, Jharkhand, Meghalaya, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Assam, Odisha, Chhattisgarh and Rajasthan still among India's ten poorest states in 2019-21; Gujarat was not among them.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Clause (d)
Article 19(1)(d) guarantees the right to move freely throughout the territory of India; (a) covers speech and expression, (b) peaceful assembly and (c) forming associations or unions.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Thang-Ta
K. Sanathoiba Sharma, a Thang-Ta guru from Manipur, received the Padma Shri in 2023 (sports) for promoting this traditional Manipuri martial art. Mukna is Manipuri wrestling, Khong Kangjei a Manipuri form of hockey and Yubi Lakpi a Manipuri game played with a greased coconut.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Arunachal Pradesh
Rikham Pada (Rikampada) is a folk dance of the Nyishi people of Arunachal Pradesh.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Atomic theory
Dalton set out his atomic theory in 'A New System of Chemical Philosophy' in 1808: elements are made of atoms, atoms combine in simple whole-number ratios to form compounds, and a chemical reaction only rearranges them.

Q.20 · Answer (C) To facilitate exchange
Money's main function is as a medium of exchange: it removes the barter system's need for a double coincidence of wants.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Edwin Lutyens
India Gate, the All India War Memorial in New Delhi, was designed by Sir Edwin Lutyens.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Sanjay Agrawal
In July 2022 the Centre set up a committee under Sanjay Agrawal, former Union Agriculture Secretary, to make MSP more effective and transparent and to promote natural farming and crop diversification.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Assam
Me-Dam-Me-Phi, the Ahom community's festival of ancestor worship, is celebrated in Assam on 31 January.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) To be completely different from each other
Two people or things 'like chalk and cheese' are completely different from each other.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Sombre
'Lively' means full of energy and cheer; its opposite is 'sombre', dark and gloomy.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Fourty
The correct spelling is 'forty', without the 'u' of 'four'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Theology
'Theology' is the study of religion. Psephology is the study of elections, philology of the history of languages and psychology of the mind.

Q.5 · Answer (D) hit the nail on the head
To 'hit the nail on the head' is to say exactly what is right about a problem. To 'sow wild oats' is to behave wildly when young, and to 'give the devil his due' is to credit someone one dislikes.

Q.6 · Answer (C) met
The past continuous sets the background and the simple past gives the event that happened during it: 'he met with an accident'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) shall win
A clause of time with 'as soon as' takes the simple present for a future event: 'As soon as I win the lottery'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) natural
Death is 'natural', part of the ordinary course of life, for humans; 'edible', 'spiral' and 'viral' make no sense here.

Q.9 · Answer (D) incompetent
The correct spelling is 'incompetent'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Dignified
'Distinguished' means commanding respect, with a dignified air: 'dignified'. 'Mediocre' is close to its opposite.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Irregular
'Periodic' means happening at regular intervals; its opposite is 'irregular'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) on safari tour
'Tour' is a singular countable noun and needs an article: 'on a safari tour'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) more cheaper
'Cheaper' is already comparative, so 'more cheaper' is a double comparative: 'the food is cheaper'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) monologue
A 'monologue' is a long speech by one person; sitting alone, he is lost in talking to himself. A synagogue is a Jewish place of worship and a prologue an introduction.

Q.15 · Answer (C) personal
The misspelt word is 'persanol'; the correct spelling is 'personal'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Directly from the person involved
To hear something 'straight from the horse's mouth' is to hear it directly from the person concerned.

Q.17 · Answer (D) No substitution required
'Presented to our senses' is a past participle phrase describing the environment (one that is presented to our senses), so the sentence is correct as it stands.

Q.18 · Answer (D) keep your ear to the ground
To 'keep your ear to the ground' is to stay well informed about what is happening, a journalist's first duty.

Q.19 · Answer (D) D
A clause of time with 'when' takes the simple present for a future event: 'when you arrive'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) in playing
One is good 'at' an activity: 'She is very good at playing the guitar'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) concern
Pollution is a growing 'concern', a cause of worry, because it poses risks to health and ecosystems.

Q.22 · Answer (B) sources
The plural verb 'vary' needs a plural noun: 'The sources of environmental pollution vary'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) As a result
'As a result of these activities' introduces their consequence; 'since', 'however' and 'therefore' cannot be followed by 'of'.

Q.24 · Answer (A) and
'And' joins the two causes: attitudes towards sustainability and lack of environmental awareness.

Q.25 · Answer (C) like
'Like' introduces examples: 'individual choices like driving'; 'example' and 'instance' would need 'for'.

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